

Deandra Lauren Rodricks

GRC + AI Strategy • Cybersecurity Analyst

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EDUCATION

Purdue University, Daniels School of Business

M.S. Business and Technology, Tech Commercialization & Governance

West Lafayette, IN • Aug 2026

Purdue University Indianapolis • University of Indianapolis

Dual B.S.: Computer Engineering (3.5 GPA) • Computer Science, Minor in Math (3.8 GPA, Magna Cum Laude)

Indianapolis, IN • May 2022

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Blackink IT

Cybersecurity Analyst, Promoted from Specialist after 2 years

Indianapolis, IN • June 2022 – June 2025

- **Risk Assessment & Control Gap Analysis:** Performed security risk assessments across 65 client environments, identified control gaps, and delivered risk-based remediation recommendations aligned to NIST CSF, CIS Controls, PCI DSS, and HIPAA.
- **Client-Facing GRC Advisory:** Served as primary GRC contact across 10 security-proactive clients, advising on Shadow IT governance, dark web exposure, and compliance posture. Authored data protection policies and supported cyber insurance reviews that directly informed board-level risk decisions.
- **Audit Readiness & Incident Response:** Prepared clients for external audits and certification efforts by documenting controls and closing evidence gaps. Delivered a full incident response tabletop exercise producing an executive-ready IR plan that translated technical threat scenarios into business risk language.
- **Operations, Awareness & Stakeholder Communication:** Ran recurring vulnerability scans, resolving up to 27 security tickets in a single day, and standardized remediation workflows across the portfolio. Led phishing simulation programs and presented security awareness outcomes to client leadership, framing technical risk in terms of organizational impact. Mentored incoming analysts on risk communication and triage.

Blackink IT, TechPoint Xtern

IT Service Intern

Indianapolis, IN • June 2021 – May 2022

- Designed an automated IT ticketing portal improving operational KPIs ~30%, and consolidated all SOPs into a centralized system improving cross-team consistency. Received TechPoint Xtern Value Award and Xtern Leader Award.
- Researched emerging cybersecurity threats and AI-driven security trends to build a technical competency matrix, aligning team capabilities with evolving risk landscapes ahead of client needs.

CREDENTIALS

Certifications: Certified in Cybersecurity, ISC2 • Business Analytics, Harvard Business School Online

Frameworks: NIST AI RMF • NIST CSF • MITRE ATLAS • OWASP LLM Top 10 • EU AI Act • SOC 2 • PCI DSS • HIPAA • CIS Controls • GDPR

Tools: SentinelOne • CrowdStrike • Microsoft Defender • Tenable • Rapid Fire Tools • Shadow IT (Saaslio) • KnowBe4 • Bitwarden • LastPass • Duo MFA • Cisco

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

AI Governance & Risk Framework for SDLC

Northern Trust • In Progress

- **Student Researcher / Lead Analyst:** Building an enterprise AI risk governance framework for a global financial institution deploying AI agents across its SDLC. Mapping AI-specific risks to NIST AI RMF, MITRE ATLAS v5.1, OWASP LLM Top 10, and EU AI Act; producing a risk taxonomy, controls-to-SDLC-phase mapping, and governance policy objectives communicated to both engineering and executive stakeholders.

AI Voice Agent

Non-Profit Ed-Tech Organization

- Designed and deployed a GCP-hosted LLM voice agent, applying AI safety controls including hallucination constraints, agent boundary enforcement, and multilingual edge case handling, demonstrating AI risk governance in a live production environment.

Lead Automation Consulting Project

Consulting LLC

- Assessed a consulting firm's analyst workflows, identified automation opportunities, and implemented LLM-driven solutions that reduced manual effort and generated a new client acquisition. Built a data-backed service scoring matrix enabling leadership to make risk-informed resource allocation decisions.

LEADERSHIP & GOVERNANCE PROJECTS

shortlist, Purdue MBT Simulated Startup

West Lafayette, IN • In Progress

- **Chief Executive Officer:** Appointed CEO of a student-built job search platform; directing product governance, organizational execution, and cross-functional team alignment across C-suite, management, and IC roles toward a fall beta launch.

Incident Response Tabletop Exercise

Non-Profit Organization

- **Project Lead:** Designed and facilitated a full incident response tabletop exercise, modeling risk across tolerance and transference levels, and delivering a board-ready IR plan that translated technical threat scenarios into organizational risk language executives could act on.